

ICDL Computer & Online Essentials - Course Outline

Duration: 16 weeks | **Certification:** ICDL Foundation | **Level:** Foundation

Module 1: Computers and Devices

- Hardware types: computers (desktops, laptops) and devices (tablets, smartphones)
- Equipment and ports: printers, scanners, USB, HDMI, VGA, Bluetooth
- Software fundamentals: operating systems vs. applications
- Device operations: login, shutdown, restart, connecting peripherals

Module 2: Managing Files and Applications

- File management: navigation, icons, file types, hierarchical structures
- Organizing: creating folders, renaming, copying, moving, deleting, restoring
- Storage types: internal/external drives, cloud storage, USB, memory cards
- Storage measurements: KB, MB, GB, TB, PB
- Applications: installing, uninstalling, troubleshooting, screen capture

Module 3: Networks

- Network concepts: sharing data, devices, and applications securely
- Downloading vs. uploading
- Internet uses: searching, communication, purchasing, banking, entertainment
- Connection types: wired, wireless, mobile networks
- Wireless security: protected vs. open networks

Module 4: Online Information

- Web fundamentals: WWW, URLs, hyperlinks, search engines
- Search techniques: keywords, exact phrases, images, advanced filters
- Information management: bookmarks, downloading files, printing web pages
- Copyright and intellectual property awareness
- Browser settings: homepage, pop-ups, cookies, clearing history and data

Module 5: Online Communication

- Communication tools: email, messaging, video calls, social networking, forums
- Email essentials: composing, To/Cc/Bcc fields, attachments, reply functions
- Email organization: folders, searching, sorting, contacts, distribution lists
- Professional communication best practices
- Calendar management: creating meetings, adding invitees and resources.
- Privacy and appropriate content guidelines.

Module 6: Safety

- Security threats: malware, unauthorized access, theft, accidental damage
- Protection strategies: anti-virus software, updates, encryption, strong passwords, backups
- Online safety: secure websites, protecting personal data, recognizing fraud
- Well-being: breaks, posture, lighting, ergonomics
- Accessibility: screen readers, magnifiers, voice recognition, high contrast
- Environmental practices: energy saving, recycling devices and consumables